City of Saint Paul

City Hall and Court House
15 West Kellogg Boulevard
Council Chambers - 3rd Floor
651-266-8560

Meeting Minutes

City Council

Council President Rebecca Noecker
Vice President Nelsie Yang
Councilmember Anika Bowie
Councilmember Molly Coleman
Councilmember Cheniqua Johnson
Councilmember Saura Jost
Councilmember HwaJeong Kim

Wednesday, September 23, 2026 **3:30 PM** **Council Chambers - 3rd Floor**

ROLL CALL

Meeting started at 3:31 PM

Present 7 - Councilmember Rebecca Noecker, Councilmember Nelsie Yang, Councilmember HwaJeong Kim, Councilmember Anika Bowie, Councilmember Saura Jost, Councilmember Cheniqua Johnson and Councilmember Molly Coleman

COMMUNICATIONS & RECEIVE/FILE

1 AO 26-65 Amending the Citywide Capital Maintenance budget for the Fleet Services division in the Office of Financial Services

Received and Filed

CONSENT AGENDA
Items listed under the Consent Agenda will be enacted by one motion with no separate discussion. If discussion on an item is desired, the item will be removed from the Consent Agenda for separate consideration.

Approval of the Consent Agenda

Council President Noecker stated that Item 21 would be taken separately.

Councilmember Yang moved approval.

Consent Agenda adopted as amended

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

2 RES 26-1352 Authorizing the Department of Planning and Economic Development to apply to the Metropolitan Council for grant proposals submitted to the Livable

Communities Act (LCA) programs for site assessment, cleanup or environmental remediation, other predevelopment activities, and or funding for new construction or redevelopment from LCA Round Two of 2026.

Adopted

3 RES 26-1365 Approving the City's cost of providing Miscellaneous Abatement services during July to August 2026, and setting date of Legislative Hearing for October 20, 2026 and City Council public hearing for January 20, 2027 to consider and levy the assessments against individual properties. (File No. J2604A, Assessment No. 268505)

Adopted

4 RES 26-1464 Approving the Memorandum of Agreement between the City of Saint Paul and the International Union of Operating Engineers, Local 70, for the purpose of providing a pilot program for off-shift differential pay for employees that are regularly scheduled to work on the weekends.

Laid over to October 7, 2026

5 RES 26-1569 Authorizing the acceptance of $66,027.29 from the MN Department of Commerce's Solar on Public Buildings Grant Program for solar installation at the Solid Waste & Recycling Facility and authorizing the execution of a grant agreement.

Adopted

6 RES 26-1576 Accepting the gift of travel expense and tuition from the Knight Foundation in partnership with the Bloomberg Center for Cities at Harvard University for Mayor Kaohly Her to attend the Leading a Government Residents Can See and Trust program from 9/28/2026 - 9/29/2026.

Adopted

7 RES 26-1583 Memorializing a City Council decision to grant the appeals of Jon Knutson, on behalf of Loucks, and Carolyn Wolf, on behalf of Tegra, from the Board of Zoning Appeals decision denying two zoning variances from City Council Resolution 23-1442 for a hotel at United Village Block D (where 43.1% window and door openings are proposed for façade length [a 6.9% variance] and 23.3% for façade area [a 6.7% variance], below the required 50% and 30%) at 1560 University Avenue West.

Adopted

8 RES 26-1584 Memorializing a City Council decision to grant the appeal of Joe Bennett from the Board of Zoning Appeals decision denying a zoning variance to convert an existing lit freestanding sign to dynamic display at 1305 7th Street West.

Adopted

9 RES 26-1586 Setting a public hearing date of November 4, 2026 for 2027 Water Rates and Charges and 2027 Water Fees and Charges.

Adopted

10 RES 26-1589 Accepting the gift of travel expense and tuition from the Knight Foundation in partnership with Harvard University for Mary Xiong to attend the Responsive Cities Network Sprint convening from 9/29/2026 - 09/30/2026.

Adopted

11 RES 26-1592 Authorizing approval of settlement and payment in full and final settlement of the employment-related claim involving former Saint Paul Fire Department employee, Jodie Carroll against the City of St. Paul.

Adopted

12 RES 26-1595 Approving the Memorandum of Agreement between the City and the Saint Paul Police Federation to provide an accelerated program for Police.

Laid over to October 7, 2026

13 RES 26-1597 Approving the application for a Gambling Location license (License ID #DSIBLLIQ-003262-2026) to be added to the existing Liquor On Sale and Liquor On Sale--Sunday licenses (License ID #DSIBLLIQ-000216-2025) held by NS LLC d/b/a Pizza Maya for the premises located at 1324 7th St. W.

Adopted

14 RES 26-1601 Authorizing the Fire Department to apply for the 2025 Hazardous Materials Emergency Preparedness (HMEP) grant from the State of Minnesota Department of Public Safety State Fire Marshal Division to provide hazardous materials training and purchase equipment.

Adopted

15 RES 26-1602 Approving the Mayor's appointment of Council President Rebecca Noecker to the Saint Paul Port Authority Board of Commissioners for a temporary term beginning on September 24, 2026.

Adopted

16 RES 26-1603 Approving the Mayor's appointment of Councilmember Cheniqua Johnson to the Board of Water Commissioners for a temporary term beginning on September 24, 2026.

Adopted

17 RES 26-1607 Approving a Public Hearing on the Issuance of Conduit Multifamily Housing Revenue Bonds by the Housing and Redevelopment Authority of the City of Saint Paul, Minnesota (the "HRA") for a Multifamily Rental Housing Development Project Located at 408 St. Peter Street; Reciting a Proposal for a Housing Finance Program Related to Such Multifamily Rental Housing Development; Approving the Related Project and Program Pursuant to Minnesota Statutes, Chapter 462C; Authorizing the HRA to Issue Conduit Multifamily Housing Revenue Bonds and Authorizing the Preparation of Necessary Documents and Materials in Connection with Said Project and

Program, and Related Documents, District 17, Ward 2.

Adopted

18 RES 26-1611 Approving the Mayor's appointment of Brian Brown, Mattias Kostov, and Rafe Stanley to the Truth-in-Sale of Housing Board.

Adopted

19 RES 26-1612 Approving the Mayor's appointment of Jon Commers to the Saint Paul Public Housing Agency (SPPHA).

Adopted

20 RES 26-1614 Authorizing the Department of Parks and Recreation to accept a gift of travel and lodging from the Cities for Financial Empowerment Fund for two staff members to attend the 2026 Bank On Leadership Training (BOLT) convening in Charlotte, North Carolina.

Adopted

FOR DISCUSSION

21 RES 26-1616 Approving the City of Saint Paul Audit Committee's next two studies concerning the Department of Safety and Inspections' Business Licensing Operations and the Public Works Department's Street Maintenance and Pothole Repair Operations, and authorizing Wilder Research to conduct the respective studies in 2026 and 2027.

Council President Noecker gave remarks and moved approval.

Adopted

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

22 RES 26-1553 Approving adverse action against the Tobacco Shop license (License ID #20100004254) held by Northern Tier Retail LLC d/b/a Speedway #4420 for the premises located at 1125 7th St. W. (Licensee will speak to Council on her own behalf).

Monica Shaffer from the City Attorney's Office gave a staff report.

Brittany Standing from Speedway addressed the City Council to ask for leniency on the penalty.

Council President Noecker moved approval of the staff-recommended penalty.

Adopted

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

23 RES 26-1588 Proclaiming September 25, 2026, as Dolly Parton Day in the City of Saint Paul.

Council President Noecker gave remarks and read from the resolution.

Donna Valentine, radio host, gave remarks.

Noecker moved approval.

Councilmember Bowie spoke in favor.

Adopted

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

RECESS

The City Council will recess to convene as the Library Board to take up RES 26-1594, Requesting that the City levy property taxes for the Saint Paul Public Library Agency. They will then adjourn the Library Board meeting and reconvene as the City Council.

Meeting recessed at 3:47 PM

ROLL CALL

Meeting resumed at 3:57 PM

Budget Items

24 RES 26-1605 Approving a 2027 maximum property tax levy for the Housing and Redevelopment Authority (HRA).

Councilmember Johnson moved approval.

Adopted

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

25 RES 26-1599 Approving a 2027 maximum property tax levy for the City.

Councilmembers Bowie, Jost, Johnson, Yang, Coleman, and Noecker gave remarks.

Noecker moved approval.

Adopted

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

ORDINANCES

An ordinance is a city law enacted by the City Council. It is read at three separate council meetings and becomes effective after passage by the Council and 30 days after publication in the Saint Paul Pioneer Press. Public hearings on ordinances are generally held at the second reading.

Final Adoption

26 Ord 26-40 Amending Appendix B of the Legislative Code relating to Northern States Power, D/B/A Xcel Energy, Gas Franchise.

Councilmember Jost spoke in favor and moved approval.

Councilmembers Johnson and Noecker spoke in favor.

Adopted

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

27 Ord 26-41 Amending Appendix C of the Legislative Code relating to Northern States Power, D/B/A Xcel Energy, Electric Franchise.

Councilmember Jost moved approval.

Adopted

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

28 Ord 26-43 Amending the Legislative Code by adding a new Appendix B-2 relating to Northern States Power, D/B/A Xcel Energy, Gas Franchise Fee.

Councilmember Jost moved approval.

Adopted

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

29 Ord 26-44 Amending the Legislative Code by adding a new Appendix C-2 relating to

Northern States Power, D/B/A Xcel Energy, Electric Franchise Fee.

Councilmember Jost moved approval.

Adopted

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

First Reading

30 Ord 26-46 Amending Chapter 51.01 of the Administrative Code, titled Disposition of City Property, Authority and procedure, to allow for conveyance of real property used by the Saint Paul Regional Water Services, to the Board of Water Commissioners.

Bruce Engelbrekt from the Office of Financial Services gave a staff report.

Laid over to October 7, 2026 for Second Reading

PUBLIC HEARINGS
Live testimony is limited to two minutes for each person. See below for optional ways to testify.

31 Ord 26-39 Amending Chapter 63 of the Legislative Code pertaining to salt storage regulation.

Council President Noecker moved Version 2. Approved 7-0.

Noecker moved to close the public hearing and lay over for two weeks.

Amended and laid over to October 7, 2026 for Final Adoption

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

32 RES PH 26-182 Ratifying the assessment for benefits, costs and expenses for the Seventh Place Mall operation and maintenance costs for 2025. File No. 18428-25, Assessment No. 257200.

Councilmember Johnson moved approval.

Adopted

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

33 RES PH 26-183 Ratifying the assessment for benefits, costs and expenses for the Seventh Place Mall operation and maintenance costs for 2026. File No. 18428-26, Assessment No. 267200.

Councilmember Yang moved approval.

Adopted

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

34 RES PH 26-193 Ratifying the assessment for benefits, costs, and expenses for the Grand/Snelling parking lot operation and maintenance costs for 2027. (File No. 18746-26, Assessment No. 267202)

Councilmember Jost moved approval.

Adopted

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

35 RES PH 26-201 Amending the 2026 Public Works General Fund Street Lighting Maintenance Accounting Unit budget by $450,000 to provide electrician support for the Regional Water Services (SPRWS) Lead Replacement Project.

Councilmember Kim moved approval.

Adopted

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

36 RES PH 26-244 Accepting grant funds, authorizing execution of a grant agreement (with indemnity obligations and other documents related thereto) and amending the operating budget with respect to the City's sponsorship of a Minnesota Department of Employment and Economic Development (DEED) Contamination Cleanup grant for the benefit of LSBD St. Paul Broadway II, LLC for its project known as Ember on Pine located at 500 Broadway Street (District 4, Ward 2).

Councilmember Coleman moved approval.

Adopted

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

37 RES PH 26-250 Authorizing the Department of Parks and Recreation to accept grant funding in the amount of $2,926,000 from the State of Minnesota and to establish a budget in the Grant Fund to reflect said funds to support arts and cultural heritage at the Como Park Zoo and Conservatory.

Councilmember Kim moved approval.

Adopted

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

38 RES PH 26-268 Amending the 2026 Saint Paul Regional Water Services budget resulting in an increase in spending and financing of $53,000 for a Metropolitan Council grant.

Councilmember Yang moved approval.

Adopted

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

LEGISLATIVE HEARING DISCUSSION ITEM

45 RLH SAO 26-66 Making finding on the appealed of Thomas Turbes to a nuisance abatement ordered for 2203 SELBY AVENUE in Council File RLH SAO 26-56.

Joanna Zimny, Legislative Hearing Officer, gave a staff report.

Thomas Turbes, appellant, spoke during the public hearing.

Council President Noecker asked how much additional time the appellant was asking for.

Turbes stated that he needed two additional weeks.

Councilmember Coleman moved to close the public hearing. Approved 7-0.

Coleman moved to grant to October 7, 2026 for compliance.

Johnson asked for clarification.

Coleman addressed Johnson's question.

Adopted as amended (granted to October 7, 2026 for compliance)

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

LEGISLATIVE HEARING CONSENT AGENDA

Items listed under the Consent Agenda will receive a combined public hearing and be enacted by one motion with no separate discussion. Items may be removed from the Consent Agenda for a separate public hearing and discussion if desired.

Approval of the Consent Agenda

Councilmember Yang moved approval.

Legislative Hearing Consent Agenda adopted as amended

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

39 RLH SAO 26-90 Making finding on the appeal of Rich C. Nelson to a nuisance abatement ordered for 2348 BUFORD AVENUE in Council File RLH SAO 26-84.

Adopted

40 RLH SAO 26-94 Making finding on the appeal of Barbara Clark to a nuisance abatement ordered for 1552 CANFIELD AVENUE in Council File RLH SAO 26-77. (September 22, 2026 Legislative Hearing)

Adopted as amended (nuisance abated)

41 RLH SAO 26-92 Making finding on the appeal of Mary Roach to a nuisance abatement ordered for 1045 CHARLES AVENUE in Council File RLH SAO 26-78.

Adopted

42 RLH SAO 26-96 Second Making finding on the appeal of Liam Magistad to a nuisance abatement ordered for 1597 CHARLES AVENUE in Council File RLH SAO 26-61.

Adopted as amended (nuisance abated)

43 RLH SAO 26-63 Making finding on the appeal of Jane Myers nuisance abatement ordered for 1521 HAGUE AVENUE in Council File RLH SAO 26-58.

Adopted as amended (nuisance abated)

44 RLH SAO 26-80 Making finding on the Appeal of Kinnell Tacket to a nuisance abatement

ordered for 444 JOHNSON PARKWAY in Council File RLH CO 26-4.

Adopted

46 RLH SAO 26-93 Making finding on the appeal of Barry Campbell to a nuisance abatement ordered for 449 VAN DYKE STREET in Council File RLH SAO 26-71.

Adopted

47 RLH AR 26-62 Ratifying the assessment for Demolition of Vacant, Nuisance and/or Hazardous Structure from the month of June 2026. (File No. J2608C, Assessment No. 262007)

Adopted

ADJOURNMENT

Meeting ended at 4:58 PM

City Council meetings are open for in person attendance, but the public may also comment on public hearing items in writing. Any comments and materials submitted by 12:00 pm of the day before the meeting will be attached to the public record and available for review by the City Council. Comments may be submitted as follows:

Written public comment on public hearing items can be submitted to Contact-Council@ci.stpaul.mn.us or CouncilHearing@ci.stpaul.mn.us. Live testimony will be taken in person in the Council Chambers.

Council Meeting Information
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